

INTERNATIONAL news

China's rare earth exports hit a six-month high in July

China's rare earth exports hit a six-month high in July, surging 69% to 6422 tons after months of volatility tied to US-China tensions. The rebound follows Beijing's easing of magnet export controls imposed earlier this year amid tariff disputes. While shipments show partial recovery, supply remains fragile, underscoring China's leverage in global advanced manufacturing supply chains.

Intel and Trump administration agree on \$8.9 billion investment deal

Intel secured an \$8.9 billion investment from the US government, which will buy a 9.9% stake to bolster domestic chipmaking and supply chains. Funded via CHIPS Act grants and the Secure Enclave programme, the deal raises total federal support to \$11.1 billion. Intel continues \$100+ billion US expansion, with Arizona fabs set to begin production.

TSMC prepares four 1.4nm chip fab facilities

TSMC will break ground in October on four 1.4nm fabs at the Central Taiwan Science Park, with mass production scheduled for 2028 and a monthly capacity of 50,000 wafers. The \$98.1 million project boosts local supply chains and cements TSMC's lead over rivals like Samsung in next-generation chips amid intensifying global foundry competition.

US-EU trade deal caps tariffs on semiconductors

The US and EU sealed a trade pact setting new rules for semiconductors and industrial goods. Washington capped tariffs at 15% on chips, drugs, and lumber, while the EU pledged to cut tariffs and expand farm imports. The deal includes \$40 billion in EU AI chip purchases, \$750 billion in US energy sales, and \$600 billion in EU investments in America.

Australia to spend \$1.1 billion on Anduril undersea drone fleet

Australia will invest \$1.1 billion in Ghost Shark undersea drones, co-developed with Anduril, to boost surveillance and strike capabilities alongside submarines and surface ships. Built in New South Wales, the first units are expected to arrive in 2026 under a five-year contract. The programme supports AUKUS goals, export prospects, and counters China's expanding Indo-Pacific naval presence.

Tesla's US EV market share falls to its lowest level since 2017

Tesla's US EV market share slipped to 38% in August, its lowest since 2017, as rivals launch new models and incentives. Once above 80%, Tesla now struggles amid high costs, expiring tax credits, and lukewarm reception for its Model Y refresh and Cybertruck. Despite challenges, its auto business dominates revenue alongside Musk's \$1 trillion pay plan.

Nvidia freezes H20 production, builds China-specific B30A chip

Nvidia is recalibrating its China strategy, halting H20 AI accelerator production after regulators questioned purchases and US-China tensions created uncertainty. Suppliers, including Amkor, Samsung, and Foxconn, were instructed to halt production. At the same time, Nvidia is developing the Blackwell-based B30A chip for China, pending US approval, aiming to balance export curbs with market demand.

Harmony Electronics to open new fab in Thailand

Harmony Electronics is set to open a new crystal resonator

facility in Om Noi, Thailand, in H2 2025, its second in the country. Targeting consumer, automotive, telecom, and AI/IoT sectors, the automated plant aims to cut supply chain risks and reduce reliance on China, Taiwan, and Japan, while aligning with carbon-reduction goals and securing global certifications.

Amkor relocates \$2 billion chip facility to larger Arizona site

Amkor Technology will build its \$2 billion semiconductor packaging and test plant on a larger 104-acre site in north Peoria, Arizona, after a land swap resolved local opposition. Backed by \$407 million in CHIPS Act funding, the facility, set to open in early 2028, will create 2000+ jobs and serve Apple, linking directly with TSMC's Arizona fabs.

ASML becomes biggest Mistral investor in boost to Europe's AI ambitions

ASML has invested \$1.5 billion in French startup Mistral AI, securing an 11% stake and becoming its largest shareholder. The funding round valued Mistral at \$11.7 billion, Europe's most valuable AI firm. The partnership will integrate AI into ASML's chip equipment, reinforcing Europe's push for AI leadership and technological sovereignty against US dominance.

SpaceX to acquire EchoStar Spectrum in \$17 billion deal

SpaceX will acquire EchoStar's wireless spectrum licences for \$17 billion to boost its Starlink satellite network and launch next-generation 5G services. The deal, partly in cash and stock, includes direct-to-cell access for Boost Mobile users, expands coverage in underserved regions, assumes \$2 billion in debt, and positions SpaceX to massively scale satellite throughput and connectivity.

Foxconn invests \$30 million in Robocore's global expansion

Foxconn has invested up to US\$30 million in Robocore's subsidiary RoboTemi Global, taking a 6.6% stake via Q-Run Holdings. The funding, tied to Robocore's IPO plans, will boost telemedicine in the US, Europe, and Japan, expand China launches, and drive global sales. Robocore expects revenue to triple in three years and grow fivefold by 2028.

GE Appliances to invest \$3 billion in US expansion

GE Appliances will invest over \$3 billion in its US operations over the next five years, boosting production, automation, and product innovation while creating more than 1000 jobs. The phased plan spans plants in Kentucky, Alabama, Georgia, Tennessee, and South Carolina, with the goal of reshoring lines from overseas. Backed by Haier, the move strengthens domestic supply chains after \$3.5 billion spent since 2016.

SoftBank invests \$2 billion in Intel

Intel has secured a \$2 billion equity injection from SoftBank, giving the Japanese group just under 2% ownership without a board seat. The deal, at \$23 per share, bolsters Intel's turnaround after a \$18.8 billion loss in 2024. It also strengthens SoftBank's US semiconductor push, following its Ohio chip-packaging project with Foxconn.

US eyes equity in Samsung and TSMC for CHIPS Act funds

The US government is considering an equity-for-subsidy model under the CHIPS Act, potentially taking stakes in firms such as TSMC, Samsung, and Intel in exchange for billions in incentives. Intel's \$7.86 billion grant could translate to a 10% US stake. Analysts warn retroactive conditions risk unsettling foreign investors and complicating global semiconductor expansion plans.